

Research based Presentation

Examining the impact of academic pressure on undergraduate students in Bangladesh in relation to institutional autonomy.

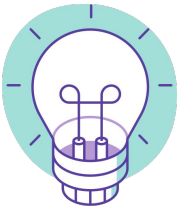
TAHMIN BATEN (21301031) Part-1

JAHANARA AKTER MEEM (22301615) Part-2

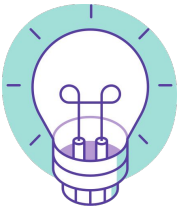
Sharzil Nafis Hossain (24101475) Part-3

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Where student pressure meets institutional power



Institutional autonomy means the ability of a university to make its own decisions about academic, administrative, and financial matters without outside control — usually from the government or political groups.

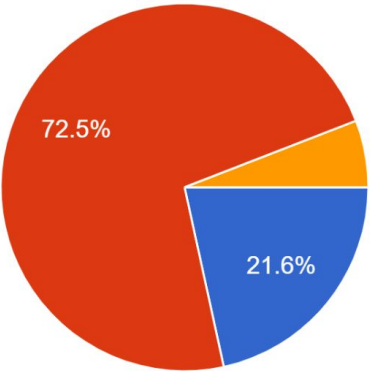


Survey Participants:(Responses)



What type of university are you currently enrolled in?

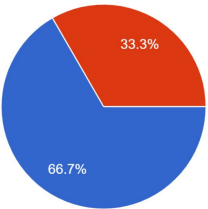
51 responses



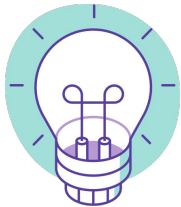
- Public
- Private
- National University
- Affiliated College

Can you specify your Gender?

42 responses

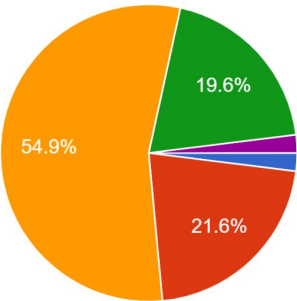


- Male
- Female
- Prefer not to say



Which year of study are you in?

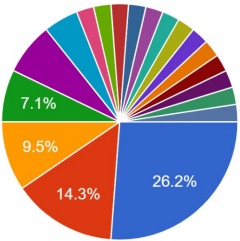
51 responses



- 1st Year
- 2nd Year
- 3rd Year
- 4th Year
- 4th Year

Can you Write down your University name

42 responses



- I would rather not
- Brac University
- I would rather not
- BRAC University
- Bracu
- Brac
- BracU
- brac university

1/3



What the Data suggests

51 undergraduate students from various universities in Bangladesh

University Type

- **Private:** 72.5% (37 students)
- **Public:** 21.6% (11 students)
- **National University:** 5.9% (3 students)
- **Affiliated College:** 0%

Year of Study

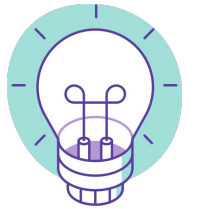
- **1st Year:** 1.9%
- **2nd Year:** 21.6%
- **3rd Year:** 54.9%
- **4th Year:** 19.6%

Gender

- **Male:** 66.7%
- **Female:** 33.3%
- **Prefer not to say:** 0%

Majority Mention: BRAC University

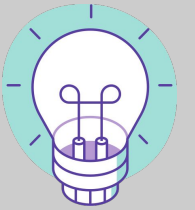
- **Total Variants Mentioned:**
 - *BRAC University(Majority)*
 - **Jessore University of Science and Technology(JUST)**
 - **KUET**
 - **Daffodil International University (DIU)**
 - **Shahjalal University of Science and Technology (SUST)**
 - **Eden Mohila College**
 - **Netrokona Govt College**
 - **North South University (NSU)**
 - **Jagannath University**
 - **University of Dhaka**
 - **others did not mention**



Survey & Analysis



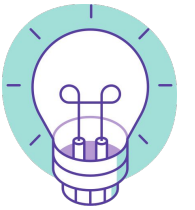
- Disproportionately high representation from **private universities**, especially BRAC University
- **Affiliated colleges** and many **public institutions** are underrepresented
- Gender distribution is uneven
- Most participants are from **3rd year**, with very few from 1st or 4th year—this may skew perceptions of academic pressure.
- Terms like "academic pressure" and "autonomy" may be interpreted **differently** by students without a consistent academic frame of reference.
- Responses to autonomy-related questions may reflect **misunderstanding or unfamiliarity** with the concept of institutional autonomy.



1. Are there significant differences in the effects of academic pressure on autonomous and government-controlled institutions?

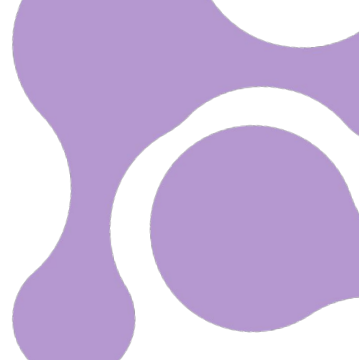
Hypothesis

Universities with higher institutional autonomy allow more academic flexibility (in course selection, assignment deadlines, and curriculum design), which reduces academic pressure on undergraduate students compared to government-controlled institutions.





Key assumptions



Students understand what “university autonomy” means—including curriculum flexibility, scheduling, and academic policies.

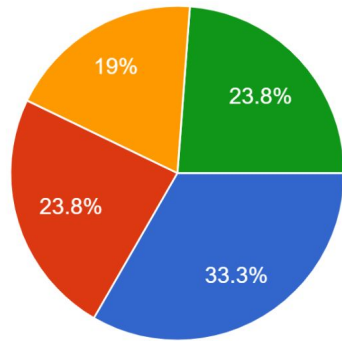
Academic pressure is partly influenced by institutional structure, not just by personal or environmental factors.

Responses reflect general institutional patterns, not isolated cases.

Responded Charts

How does the level of university autonomy affect your ability to choose elective courses?

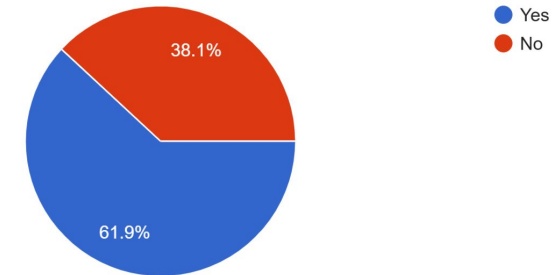
42 responses



- A) High autonomy allows more course choices.
- B) Low autonomy limits course options.
- C) Autonomy has no impact on course selection.
- D) I'm not sure how autonomy affects this.

Does your university's level of autonomy influence the flexibility of assignment submission deadlines

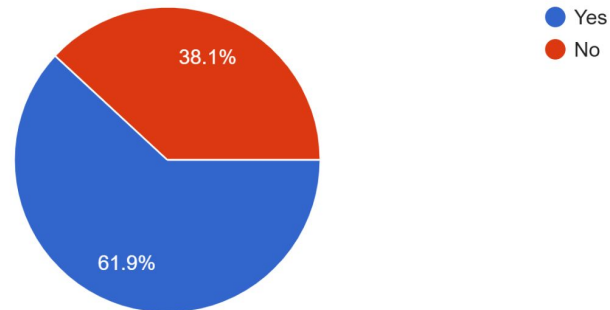
42 responses



- Yes
- No

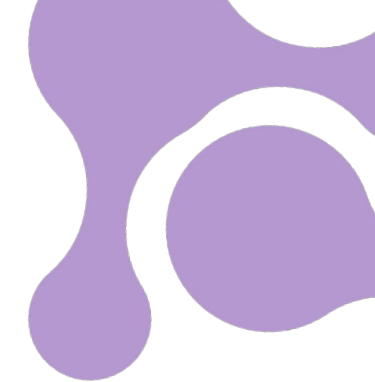
Does your university's level of autonomy influence the flexibility of assignment submission deadlines

42 responses



- Yes
- No

Survey analysis



➡ About one-third of students believe autonomy improves course options. However, nearly **24% are unsure**, indicating confusion or lack of clarity—even in autonomous institutions.

➡ : A **majority of students (62%)** say their university's autonomy does **not impact** assignment deadline flexibility—suggesting that administrative autonomy **may not be benefiting students practically**.

➡ a: While views are varied, a notable number of students associate **lack of autonomy with increased academic pressure**, especially in **affiliated or government institutions**.

Limitations

1. **Private university bias** – Most respondents are from private institutions.
2. **Public views missing** – Few responses from public university students.
3. **Low awareness** – Many students unsure how autonomy affects them.
4. **Subjective answers** – Responses based on opinions, not hard data.
5. **Hypothetical bias** – Some questions are based on imagined scenarios.

Part 2



EXPLORE WHETHER THE ACADEMIC CALENDAR AND EXAM SYSTEM AFFECT THE STUDENTS STRESS AND PERFORMANCE.

HYPOTHESIS

The academic calendar and exam system significantly influence students' stress levels and academic performance, potentially impacting their overall well-being and outcomes.



significance of the study

Improved Academic Planning

The study can help educational institutions design academic calendars and exam schedules that minimize student stress and enhance performance.

Policy Development

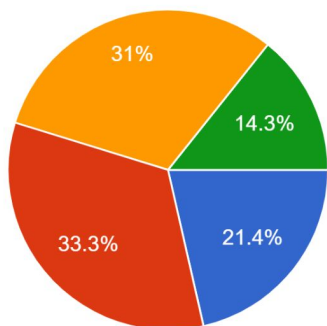
Findings may inform policy changes aimed at creating more balanced and effective academic systems to support student success.



Survey and Charts

Which part of the academic calendar do you feel contributes most to your stress as a student?

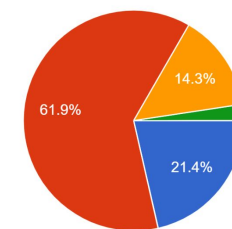
42 responses



- A. Short breaks or limited holidays between semesters
- B. Tightly packed exam schedules
- C. Unbalanced distribution of coursework throughout the semester
- D. Lack of time for extracurricular activities due to academic pacing
- E. None of the above

How do frequent high-stakes exams (such as midterms or finals) affect your academic performance and well-being?

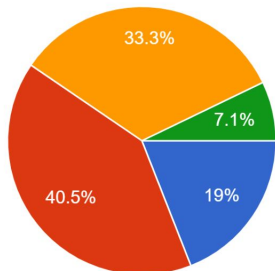
42 responses



- Help improve memory and long-term learning
- Increase anxiety and reduce motivation
- Encourage focused and deeper learning
- Do not have much effect either way

What is a possible advantage of spreading exams evenly throughout the academic year?

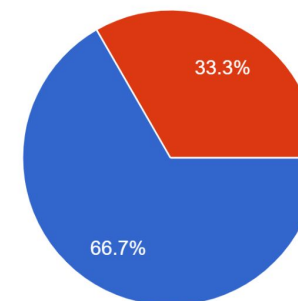
42 responses



- Reduces last-minute cramming and stress
- Improves time management and steady learning
- Increases academic workload unnecessarily
- Has little or no impact on overall performance

Do you think taking exams more often brings good performance for students

42 responses



- yes
- no

BASED ON THE SURVEY RESULTS FROM THE SURVEY

1. 🧠 33.3% OF STUDENTS SAY TIGHTLY PACKED EXAM SCHEDULES ARE THE MAIN STRESS FACTOR.
2. 📚 31% REPORT UNBALANCED COURSEWORK AS A MAJOR STRESS CONTRIBUTOR.
3. 😞 61.9% FEEL FREQUENT HIGH-STAKES EXAMS INCREASE ANXIETY AND LOWER MOTIVATION.
4. 📅 40.5% BELIEVE SPREADING EXAMS HELPS WITH TIME MANAGEMENT AND LEARNING.
5. ❌ MAJORITY SAY MORE FREQUENT EXAMS DO NOT IMPROVE PERFORMANCE.

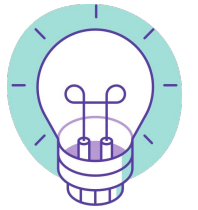


Problem Statement

Impact of Institutional Autonomy on Academic Pressure: Effects on Mental Health and Career Preparation

Hypothesis

Limited institutional autonomy increases academic pressure on undergraduate students, which negatively affects their mental well-being and hinders their career preparation by restricting curriculum relevance and scheduling flexibility





Significance of the Study

**Provides insights
for university
administrators to
improve scheduling
flexibility and
curriculum
relevance.**

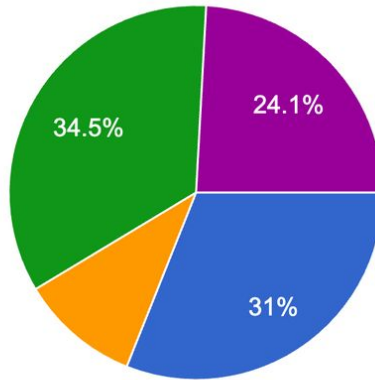
**Empowers
students to
advocate for
better mental
health support
systems.**

**Contributes to
broader educational
policy reforms in
Bangladesh,
promoting student
well-being and
career readiness.**

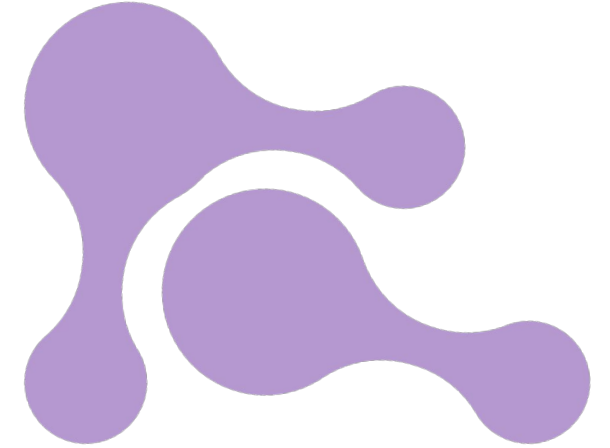
Results

"The academic pressure I face at my university negatively affects my mental well-being."

29 responses

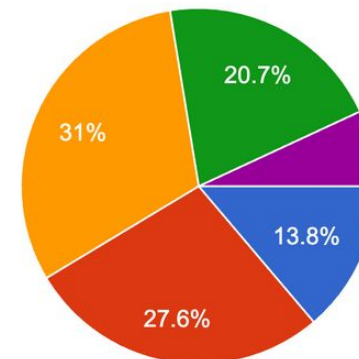


- Strongly disagree
- Disagree
- Neutral
- Agree
- Strongly agree

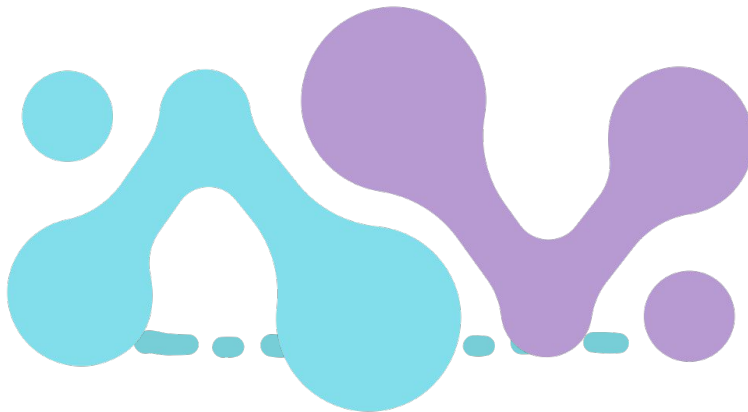


Do you believe that your university's curriculum is up-to-date and relevant to current job market demands?

29 responses

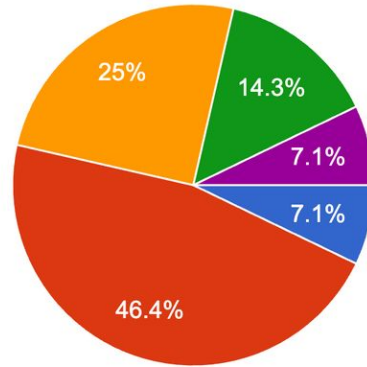


- Not at all relevant
- Somewhat outdated
- Adequately relevant
- Very relevant
- Exceptionally relevant



In your opinion, does the lack of institutional autonomy limit your university's ability to provide a better educational experience that supports both yo...(e.g., concentration, sleep, mood, or motivation)?

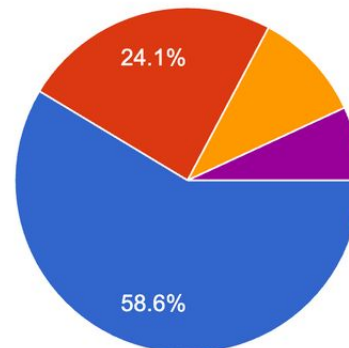
28 responses



- Not at all – I manage my academic responsibilities without significant stress.
- Occasionally – I feel overwhelmed during particularly busy times, but it d...
- Moderately often – I experience periods of stress that sometimes affect my dail...
- Frequently – I regularly struggle to cope, and it noticeably impacts my daily fun...
- Almost constantly – Academic pressure is a persistent source of stress that aff...

Imagine you have taken 4 courses in this semester and 3 of the courses have their final exam dates at the same day pre-scheduled(which you have no c... your mental health and academic performance?

29 responses



- stressed and anxious, which might negatively affect my exam performance.
- stressed but still manage to perform adequately.
- calm and confident despite the schedule changes.
- demotivated and consider seeking help or support.
- overwhelmed to the point of being unable to focus or perform well.

Overall Description

This research explores the relationship between institutional autonomy, academic pressure, and their effects on mental health and career preparation among undergraduate students in Bangladesh. Key findings include:

- **58.6% of students feel stressed and anxious when facing overlapping exam schedules, potentially affecting academic performance.**
- **34.5% agree that academic pressure negatively impacts their mental well-being.**
- **Only 20.7% find their university curriculum very or exceptionally relevant to current job market demands.**
- **46.4% believe lack of institutional autonomy significantly limits a better educational experience that supports mental health and career preparation.**

These findings highlight the need for greater institutional autonomy to reduce academic pressure and improve student outcomes.

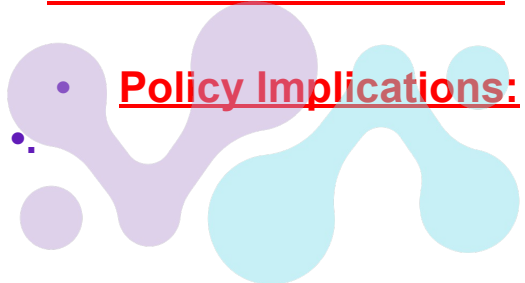
5.Types of gaps which links institutional autonomy systems that impact undergraduate students



Hypothesis

When institutional autonomy is not fully aligned with Bangladesh's educational system—especially in curriculum design and administration—it leads to increased academic pressure on undergraduates due to outdated courses, rigid schedules, and slow decision-making

- **Relevance to Context:** Government control issues limit university independence
- **Student-Centric Focus:** Student-centered approaches need institutional flexibility
- **Policy Implications:** Balance between oversight and independence needs refinement



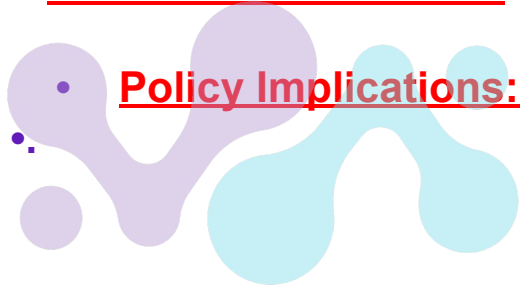
5. Types of gaps which links institutional autonomy systems that impact undergraduate students



Hypothesis

When institutional autonomy is not fully aligned with Bangladesh's educational system—especially in curriculum design and administration—it leads to increased academic pressure on undergraduates due to outdated courses, rigid schedules, and slow decision-making

- **Relevance to Context:** Government control issues limit university independence
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Relevance to the survey

Probe autonomy's impact on pressure through control, flexibility, and efficiency.

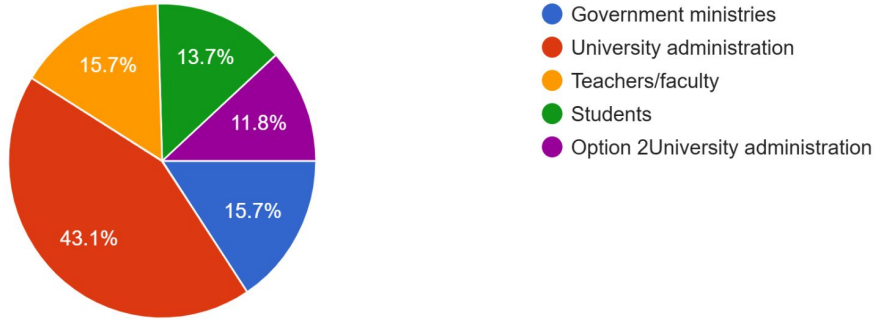
Uses clear, humorous options to encourage honest, relatable responses.

Responses of different background of University students in the mixed variation of questions to understand the differences and similarities

Surveys on Gaps and control:

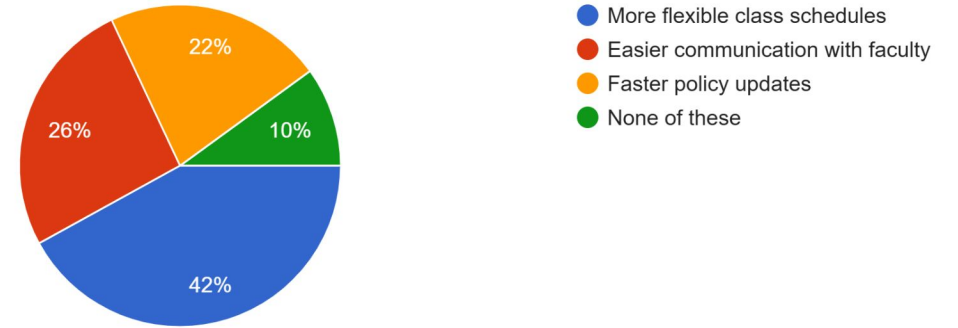
Who do you think has the most control over your university's academic decisions?

51 responses



If your university could make independent decisions (e.g., on course design, exam policies), what would be most helpful to students?

50 responses



How effectively does your university respond to student concerns about academic policies?

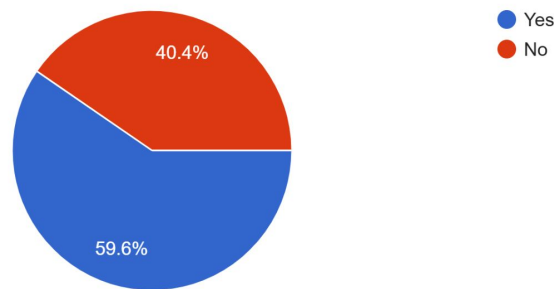
51 responses



Surveys

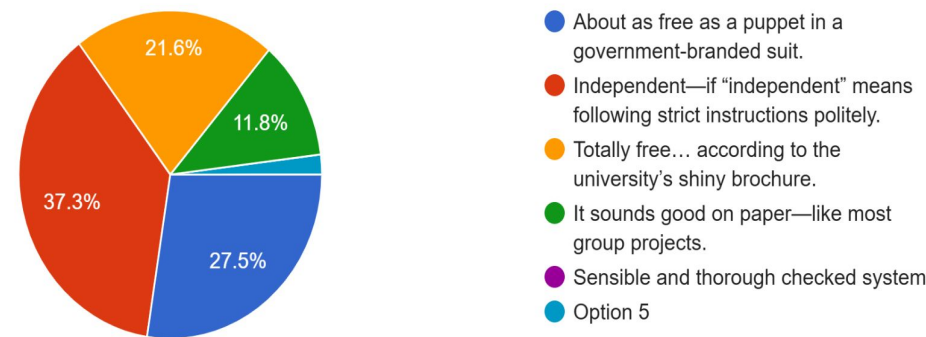
Do you believe more institutional autonomy would lead to better academic outcomes for students?

47 responses



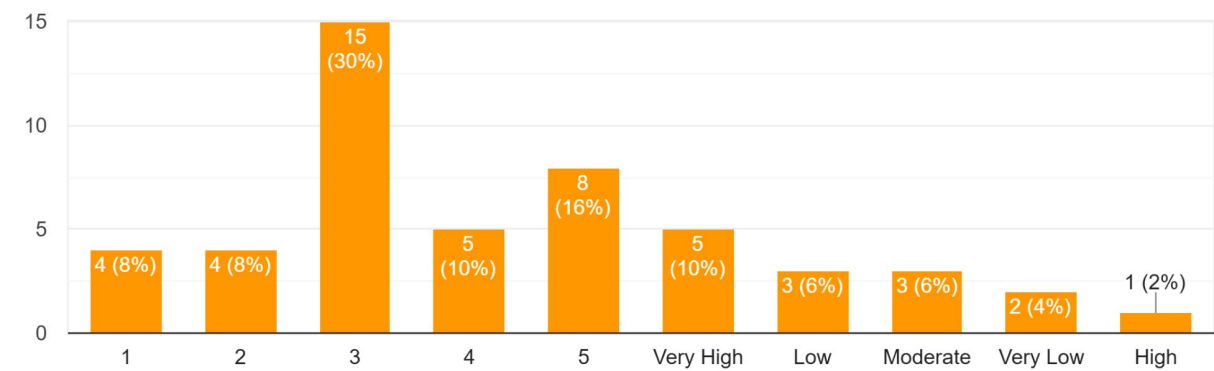
In your opinion, how much freedom does your university really have when it comes to making decisions that benefit students?

51 responses



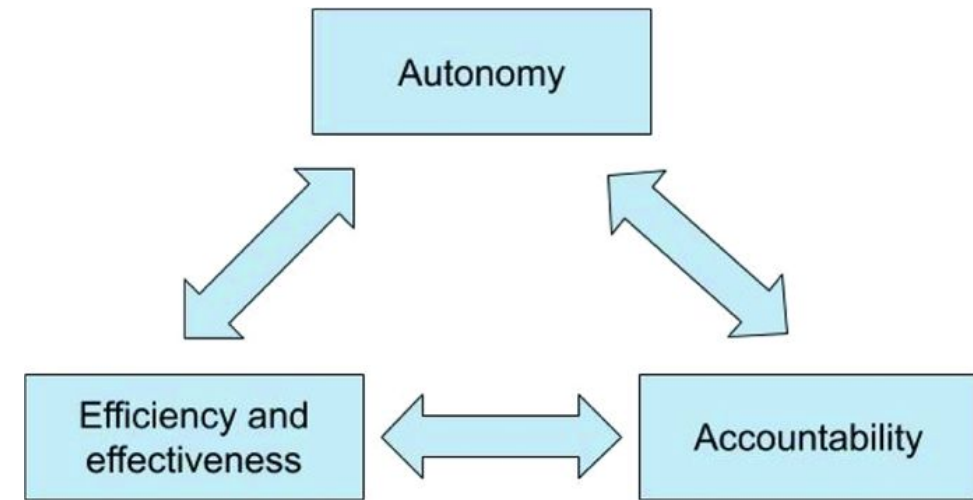
How would you rate the level of student participation in university-level decision-making?

50 responses



Survey Overview:

- **Control Split:** 55% (28/51) see university admin in charge, 15.7% (8/51) government—autonomy is partial.
- **Flexibility Demand:** 42% (21/50) prioritize flexible schedules, showing rigid systems drive pressure.
- **Slow Responses from registrar:** 51% (29.4% slow, 21.6% delayed) note inefficient responses, a gap in autonomy's execution.
- **Limited Freedom:** 64.8% (37.3% limited, 27.5% puppet-like) view autonomy as restricted, a policy-practice gap.
- **Low Student Participation:** 30% (15/50) rate participation moderate, 16% (8/50) high, 10% (5/50) very low—students have limited decision-making roles.
- **Outcome Optimism:** 59.6% (28/47) believe more autonomy improves outcomes, 40.4% (19/47) disagree—mixed views on autonomy's potential.



Survey Overview:

- Autonomous body controlled students suggest their lack of efforts
- Students are mostly in need of flexible time managements to counter their stress
- Humorous clash in responded negatives.
- Lack of Confidence for Student participation and Management
- Possible better outcome in their thoughts.
Less participation of Government controlled autonomy Universities.
- Quantitatively less number for survey outcome



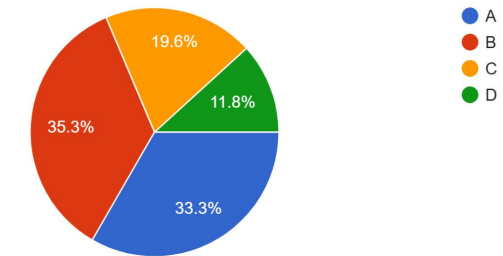
Conclusion

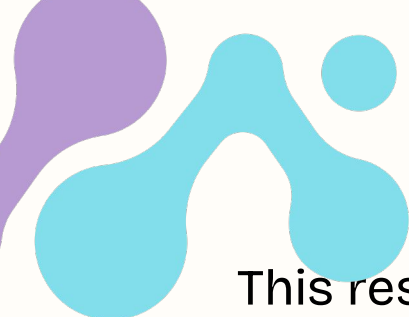
Research suggest an update on some major actions of University Governing bodies
Statistically the mass doesn't go against the system but shared their criticisms on the cause
Students still has showed their progressive support towards a better change

An Imagery choice that mostly contradicts the support from students to the controlling body

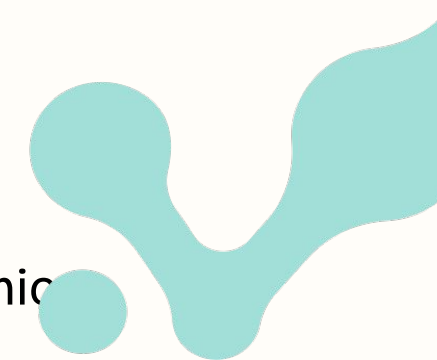
If you had to picture your University decision making autonomy which one of these pictures would describe the best ?

51 responses





Overall Description



This research explores the relationship between institutional autonomy, academic pressure, and their effects on mental health and career preparation among undergraduate students in Bangladesh. Key findings include:

while BRAC University dominated the responses, the wide variation in how it was referenced highlights the need for clearer guidelines in survey design. Additionally, the presence of multiple institutions suggests a diverse respondent pool, reflecting the broader academic landscape.

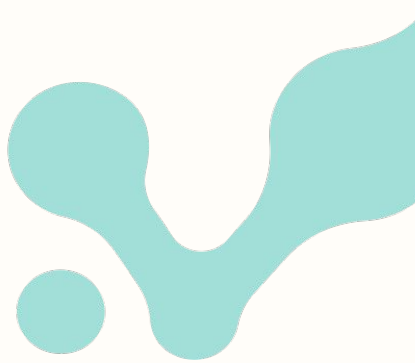
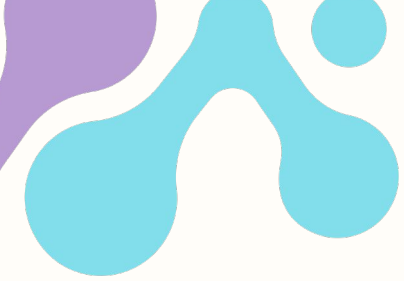
This small survey not only illustrates how individuals refer differently to the same institution but also offers a glimpse into the diverse educational backgrounds of the participants.

Problem Statement:

Examining the primary sources of academic stress of undergraduate students

Hypothesis:

Undergraduate students in Bangladesh primarily experience academic stress due to high academic workload, examination pressure, and lack of time management skills.

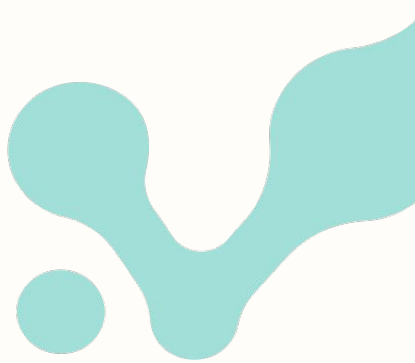
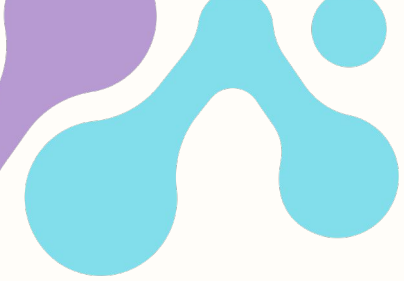


Significance of the Study

**Understanding the
primary factors
contributing to
academic stress**

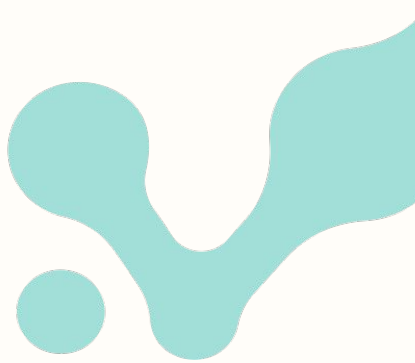
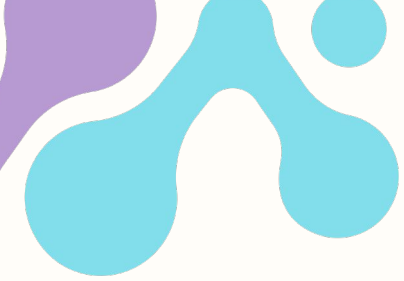
**Examining the
impact of
academic stress
on students'
mental health**

**Exploring the
effects of family
expectations on
students' mental
health**



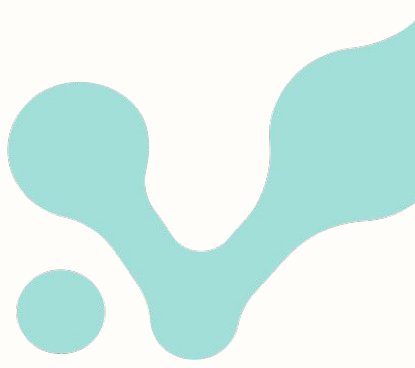
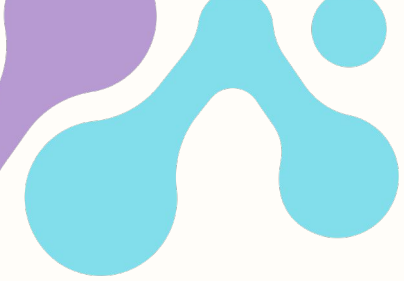
Survey results





Survey results





Overall Description

This research helps us understand in depth of the factors that causes academic stress and also the link/effect it has with the mental and physical health of the students. Key Findings:

- 24/54 (57.1%) chose heavy course load and exam frequency as the biggest source of academic pressure.
- 16/54(38.1%) chose level 4(medium extreme) for the factors that contribute to their academic stress.
- 31% of the participants feels "pressured but motivated" and 33.3% feels "highly stressed and anxious" in response to high expectations from their family for better performances.
- 85.7% agrees that overwhelming academic demands affects their mental and physical health.
 - In open ended questions, 4/54 (9.5%) participants wrote "Exams" as their answer to the biggest contributor to academic pressure in their university life.